

01. The Rise of Nationalism in Europe

01. What do you mean by nationalism?

Loyalty and devotion towards a country or sense of pride for your country is called nationalism.

02. What is absolutism?

Literally, a government or a system of rule that has no restraints on the power exercised. In history, the term refers to a form of monarchical government that was centralized, militarized and repressive.

03. What do you mean by Utopian vision?

A vision of a society that is so ideal that it is unlikely to actually exist.

04. Who was Frédéric Sorrieu and explain what he visualized in his dream?

- Frédéric Sorrieu was a French artist who prepared a series of four prints visualizing his dream of a world made up of 'democratic and social Republics'.
- In first print of the series, shows the people of Europe and America - men and women of all Ages and social classes - marching in a long train, and offering homage to the Statue of Liberty as they pass by it.
- The French Revolution was personified Liberty as a female figure who hold the torch of enlightenment in one hand and the Charter of Rights of Man in the other. On the earth in the of the image lie the shattered remains of the symbols of absolutist institutions. In Sorrieu's utopian vision, the peoples of the world are grouped as distinct nations, identified through their flags and national costume. Leading the procession, way past the Statue of Liberty, are the United States and Switzerland, which by this time were already nation-states. France, identifiable by the revolutionary tricolor, has just reached the statue.

05. What led to the emergence of feeling of nationalism in Europe?

During the nineteenth century, nationalism emerged as a force which brought about sweeping changes in the political and mental world of Europe. The end result of these changes was the emergence of the nation-state in place of the multi-national dynastic empires of Europe. The concept and practices of a modern state, in which a centralised power exercised sovereign control over a clearly defined territory, had been developing over a long period of time in Europe. But a nation-state was one in which the majority of its citizens, and not only its rulers, came to develop a sense of common identity and shared history or descent. This commonness did not exist from time immemorial; it was forged through struggles, through the actions of leaders and the common people.

06. Define plebiscite.

A direct vote by which all the people of a region are asked to accept or reject a proposal.

07. Define nation-state.

A body of people who are united by same caste, culture, political system and common interest can be defined as a nation.

08. Explain any three features of the nation that emerged in Europe in the twentieth century.

- The correct and practices of a modern state with sovereign centralized power developed in Europe.
- Nation state was supposed to be a state where majority of its citizens shared common identity and history.

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- Nations began to be personified that is they were represented as a person with characteristics that identified their nation. Mainly female figures were used to portray the nation.

Session 1 –

01. What kind of political and constitutional changes was brought about by the French Revolution?

- The first clear expression of nationalism came with the French Revolution in 1789.
- France was a full-fledged territorial state in 1789 under the rule of an absolute monarch.
- The political and constitutional changes that came in the wake of the French Revolution led to the transfer of sovereignty from the monarchy to a body of French citizens. The revolution would henceforth constitute the nation and shape its destiny.

02. Describe any five steps taken by the French Revolutionaries to create a sense of collective identity among the French people.

OR

“The first clear expression... 1789”. Explain the statement. (Any 5 points)

- The ideas of *la patrie* (the fatherland) and *le citoyen* (the citizen) emphasised the notion of a united community enjoying equal rights under a constitution.
- A new French flag, the tricolour, was chosen to replace the former royal standard.
- The Estates General was elected by the body of active citizens and renamed the National Assembly.
- New hymns were composed, oaths taken and martyrs commemorated, all in the name of the nation.
- A centralised administrative system was put in place and it formulated uniform laws for all citizens within its territory.
- Internal customs duties and dues were abolished and a uniform system of weights and measures was adopted.
- Regional dialects were discouraged and French, as it was spoken and written in Paris, became the common language of the nation.

03. State any 5 provisions of the Civil Code of 1804?

OR

Explain the features of Napoleonic Code?

OR

Mention the reforms/changes introduced by Napoleon in 1804.

- Through a return to monarchy Napoleon had, no doubt, destroyed democracy in France, but in the administrative field he had incorporated revolutionary principles in order to make the whole system more rational and efficient.
- The Civil Code of 1804 – usually known as the Napoleonic Code – did away with all privileges based on birth, established equality before the law and secured the right to property.
- In the Dutch Republic, in Switzerland, in Italy and Germany, Napoleon simplified administrative divisions, abolished the feudal system and freed peasants from serfdom and manorial dues.

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- In the towns too, guild restrictions were removed. Transport and communication systems were improved. Peasants, artisans, workers and new businessmen enjoyed a new-found freedom.
- Businessmen and small-scale producers of goods, in particular, began to realise that uniform laws, standardised weights and measures, and a common national currency would facilitate the movement and exchange of goods and capital from one region to another.

Session 2 –

01. How was the Habsburg Empire a patchwork of many different regions and people of Europe?

- The Habsburg Empire that ruled over Austria-Hungary.
- It included the Alpine regions – the Tyrol, Austria and the Sudetenland – as well as Bohemia, where the aristocracy was predominantly German-speaking. It also included the Italian-speaking provinces of Lombardy and Venetia.
- In Hungary, half of the population spoke Magyar while the other half spoke a variety of dialects. In Galicia, the aristocracy spoke Polish. Besides these three dominant groups, there also lived within the boundaries of the empire, a mass of subject peasant peoples – Bohemians and Slovaks to the north, Slovenes in Carniola, Croats to the south, and Roumans to the east in Transylvania.
- The only tie binding these diverse groups together was a common allegiance to the emperor.

02. How did the growth of industrialisation change the social and political equation in Europe?

OR

What led to the emergence of new middle class in Europe?

- In Western and parts of Central Europe the growth of industrial production and trade meant the growth of towns and the emergence of commercial classes whose existence was based on production for the market.
- Industrialisation began in England in the second half of the eighteenth century, but in France and parts of the German states it occurred only during the nineteenth century.
- In its wake, new social groups came into being: a working-class population, and middle classes made up of industrialists, businessmen, professionals.
- In Central and Eastern Europe these groups were smaller in number till late nineteenth century.
- It was among the educated, liberal middle classes that ideas of national unity following the abolition of aristocratic privileges gained popularity.

03. What is Liberalism? Explain liberalism in political and economic field in Europe in the nineteenth century.

The term 'liberalism' derives from the Latin root *liber*, meaning free. For the new middle classes, liberalism stood for freedom for the individual and equality of all before law.

[i] Political liberalism – Politically, it emphasised the concept of government by consent.

Since the French Revolution, liberalism had stood for the end of autocracy and clerical

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privileges, a constitution and representative government through parliament.

Nineteenth-century liberals also stressed the inviolability of private property.

- [ii] Economic liberalism – In the economic sphere, liberalism stood for the freedom of markets and the abolition of state-imposed restrictions on the movement of goods and capital.

04. What was *elle*?

The measuring unit of cloth used in Germany during nineteenth century.

05. When and why was the *zollverein* formed?

In 1834, a customs union or *zollverein* was formed at the initiative of Prussia and joined by most of the German states. The union abolished tariff barriers and reduced the number of currencies from over thirty to two. The creation of a network of railways further stimulated mobility, harnessing economic interests to national unification.

06. What is *zollverein*?

Coalition of German states formed to manage tariffs, economic policies within their territories.

07. What is conservatism?

A political philosophy that stressed the importance of tradition, established institutions and customs, and preferred gradual development to quick change.

08. What views did the conservatives hold?

OR

What was the basic philosophy of the conservatives?

- Following the defeat of Napoleon in 1815, European governments were driven by a spirit of conservatism.
- Conservatives believed that established, traditional institutions of state and society – like the monarchy, the Church, social hierarchies, property and the family – should be preserved.
- Most conservatives, however, did not propose a return to the society of pre-revolutionary days. Rather, they realised, from the changes initiated by Napoleon, that modernisation could in fact, strengthen traditional institutions like the monarchy.
- It could make state power more effective and strong. A modern army, an efficient bureaucracy, a dynamic economy, the abolition of feudalism and serfdom could strengthen the autocratic monarchies of Europe.

09. How did the Treaty of Vienna come into being? Who hosted the Congress of Vienna?

In 1815, representatives of the European powers – Britain, Russia, Prussia and Austria – who had collectively defeated Napoleon, met at Vienna to draw up a settlement for Europe. The Congress was hosted by the Austrian Chancellor Duke Metternich. The delegates drew up the Treaty of Vienna of 1815 with the object of undoing most of the changes that had come about in Europe during the Napoleonic wars.

10. What was the main aim of the Treaty of Vienna?

The main aim of the Treaty of Vienna was to undo the most of the changes that had come about in Europe during the Napoleonic wars.

11. How did the French territory undergo changes due to the Treaty of Vienna in 1815?

The French territory undergoes changes due to the Treaty of Vienna in 1815 in the following ways –

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- The Bourbon dynasty, which had been deposed during the French Revolution, was restored to power.
- France lost the territories it had annexed under Napoleon.
- A series of states were set up on the boundaries of France to prevent French expansion in future. The kingdom of the Netherlands, which included Belgium, was set up in the north and Genoa was added to Piedmont in the south.
- Prussia was given important new territories on its western frontiers, while Austria was given control of northern Italy.
- In the east, Russia was given part of Poland while Prussia was given a portion of Saxony.

12. Explain 3 beliefs of the conservatives that emerged after 1815.

- Conservative regimes set up in 1815 were autocratic.
- They did not tolerate criticism and dissent.
- They sought to curb activities that questioned the legitimacy of autocratic governments.
- Most of them imposed censorship laws to control what was said in newspapers, books, plays and songs and reflected the ideas of liberty and freedom associated with the French Revolution.

13. What was the major issue taken by liberal-nationalists?

One of the major issues taken up by the liberal-nationalists, who criticised the new conservative order, was freedom of the press.

14. Who was Guiseppe Mazzini?

Guiseppe Mazzini was an Italian Revolutionary. Born in Genoa in 1805, he became a member of the secret society of the Carbonari. As a young man of 26, he was sent into exile in 1831 for attempting a revolution in Liguria. He subsequently founded two more underground societies, first, Young Italy in Marseilles, and then, Young Europe in Berne, whose members were like-minded young men from Poland, France, Italy and the German states.

15. Name two secret societies created by Mazzini. (Any 2)

- [i] Carbonari
- [ii] Young Italy in Marseilles
- [iii] Young Europe in Berne

16. How has Metternich described Mazzini?

Metternich described Mazzini as the most dangerous enemy of our social order.

Session 3 –

01. Who remarked ‘When France sneezes, the rest of Europe catches cold’?

Metternich.

02. How did the Greek war of independence mobilise nationalist feelings among their educated elite across Europe?

Greece had been part of the Ottoman Empire since the fifteenth century. The growth of revolutionary nationalism in Europe sparked off a struggle for independence amongst the Greeks which began in 1821. Nationalists in Greece got support from other Greeks living in exile and also from many West Europeans who had sympathies for ancient Greek culture. Poets and artists lauded Greece as the cradle of European civilisation and mobilised public opinion to support its struggle against a Muslim empire. The English poet Lord Byron

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organised funds and later went to fight in the war, where he died of fever in 1824. Finally, the Treaty of Constantinople of 1832 recognised Greece as an independent nation.

03. When was the Treaty of Constantinople signed?

The Treaty of Constantinople of 1832 recognised Greece as an independent nation.

04. What is Romanticism?

A movement in arts and literature that originated in the late 18th century.

05. Explain any 3 reasons for the nationalist upsurge in the nineteenth century in Europe.

- Apart from wars and territorial expansion, culture played an important role in creating the idea of the nation: art and poetry, stories and music helped express and shape nationalist feelings.
- Romantic artists created a sense of a shared collective heritage, a common cultural past, as the basis of a nation.
- The emphasis on vernacular language and the collection of local folklore was not just to recover an ancient national spirit, but also to carry the modern nationalist message to large audiences who were mostly illiterate.

06. Explain any 3 ways in which nationalist feelings were kept alive Poland in the 18th century.

OR

Language played an important role in developing nationalism. Explain.

- Poland had been partitioned at the end of the eighteenth century by the Great Powers – Russia, Prussia and Austria. Even though Poland no longer existed as an independent territory, national feelings were kept alive through music and language.
- Karol Kurpinski, for example, celebrated the national struggle through his operas and music, turning folk dances like the polonaise and mazurka into nationalist symbols.
- In 1831, an armed rebellion against Russian rule took place which was ultimately crushed. Following this, many members of the clergy in Poland began to use language as a weapon of national resistance. Polish was used for Church gatherings and all religious instruction.
- As a result, a large number of priests and bishops were put in jail or sent to Siberia by the Russian authorities as punishment for their refusal to preach in Russian. The use of Polish came to be seen as a symbol of the struggle against Russian dominance.

07. Explain any 4 economic hardships that Europe faced in the 1830s?

OR

Why the 1830s were called as the years of Great Economic Hardships in Europe?

The 1830s were called as the years of Great Economic Hardships in Europe because of the following reasons –

- The first half of the nineteenth century saw an enormous increase in population all over Europe. In most countries there were more seekers of jobs than employment.
- Population from rural areas migrated to the cities to live in overcrowded slums and earned bread.
- Small producers in towns were often faced with stiff competition from imports of cheap machine-made goods from England, where industrialisation was more advanced than on the continent.

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- In those regions of Europe where the aristocracy still enjoyed power, peasants struggled under the burden of feudal dues and obligations. The rise of food prices or a year of bad harvest led to widespread pauperism in town and country.

08. What is the significance of 1848 for France and the rest Europe? What did the liberals demand?

- Parallel to the revolts of the poor, unemployed and starving peasants and workers in many European countries in the year 1848, a revolution led by the educated middle classes was under way. Events of February 1848 in France had brought about the abdication of the monarch and a republic based on universal male suffrage had been proclaimed.
- In other parts of Europe where independent nation-states did not yet exist – such as Germany, Italy, Poland, the Austro-Hungarian Empire – men and women of the liberal middle classes combined their demands for constitutionalism with national unification.
- They took advantage of the growing popular unrest to push their demands for the creation of a nation-state on parliamentary principles – a constitution, freedom of the press and freedom of association.
- The issue of extending political rights to women was a controversial one within the liberal movement, in which large numbers of women had participated actively over the years. Women had formed their own political associations, founded newspapers and taken part in political meetings and demonstrations.

Session 4 –

01. Explain the process of unification in Germany.

- The first attempt for the unification of Germany was made by liberals in 1848 through the establishment of a constitutional monarchy under the Prussian King Wilhelm IV by convening a Parliament at the Church of St. Paul in the city of Frankfurt. The Prussian king rejected this move and joined the other monarchs to oppose the elected assembly.
- There was widespread nationalist feel among middle-class Germans who in 1848 tried to unite the different regions of the German confederation into nation state.
- Prussia took the initiative and leadership of the movement for national unification. Otto von Bismarck, the Chief Minister of Prussia with the help of Prussian army and bureaucracy carried the process further.
- He fought three wars over seven years against Austria, Denmark and France which ended in Prussian victory. The victory completed the process of German unification.
- Prussian King William I was proclaimed as German Emperor at the Palace of Versailles on 18 January 1871.

02. Who was the architect of the process of German unification?

Otto von Bismarck.

03. Which state led to the unification of Germany?

Prussia.

04. Who were junkers?

The large land owners in Prussia were called as junkers.

- The End -